produces `b/a/foo`, whereas the command:

```
rsync -a a/ b
```

produces `b/foo`. The presence or absence of a trailing slash on the destination argument (b, in this case) has no effect.

10.3 Using the --delete flag

If a file was originally in both source/ and destination/ (from an earlier rsync, for example), and you delete it from source/, you probably want it to be deleted from destination/ on the next rsync. However, the default behavior is to leave the copy at destination/ in place. Assuming you want rsync to delete any file from destination/ that is not in source/, you'll need to use the `--delete` flag:

```
rsync -a --delete source/ destination/
```

10.4 Be lazy: use cron

One of the toughest obstacles to a good backup strategy is human nature; if there's any work involved, there's a good chance backups won't happen. Fortunately, there's a way to harness human laziness: make cron do the work.

To run the rsync-with-backup command from the previous section every morning at 4:20 AM, for example, edit the root cron table: (as root)

```
crontab -e
```

Then add the following line

```
20 4 * * * rsync -a --delete source/ destination/
```

Finally, save the file and exit. The backup will happen every morning at precisely 4:20 AM, and root will receive the output by email. Don't copy that example verbatim, though; you should use full path names (such as `/usr/bin/rsync` and `/home/source/`) to remove any ambiguity.

10.5 Incremental backups with rsync

Since making a full copy of a large filesystem can be a time-consuming and expensive process, it is common to make full backups only once a week or once a month, and store only changes on the other days. These are called "incremental" backups, and are supported by the venerable old dump and tar utilities, along with many others.

However, you don't have to use tape as your backup medium; it is both possible and vastly more efficient to perform incremental backups with `rsync`.

The most common way to do this is by using the `rsync -b --backup-dir=` combination. We've seen examples of that usage here, but we won't discuss it further, because there is a better way. If you're not familiar with